Superintendent's Report

Together, We Rise

January 7, 2025



School Board Recognition Month

Thank you

SCHOOL BOARD MEMBERS!

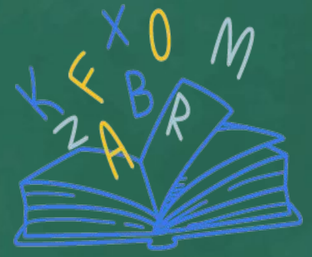




Final Community Transition Team Meeting

January 23, 2025

Improving Education for American Indian & Alaska Native Students



PRIORITY 1

Advance Literacy



PRIORITY 2

Build Trust and Relationships Across Our City



PRIORITY 3

Strengthen Safe, Supportive and Well Maintained Schools

Let’s start with Academic Support & Mentorship

We are dedicated to maintaining culturally specific support through tutoring and mentorship programs. In partnership with our Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) team, this work will continue to be funded for no less than $600,000 through our PPS budget. These programs will prioritize the needs of Native students by grounding support in culturally relevant ways and will prioritize the Cully neighborhood.

To enhance academic support, **we are immediately dedicating funds for an additional 100 hours of tutoring**, ensuring academic achievement and cultural connection remain priorities.

Next, we'll ensure Investment in Native Curriculum & Projects

In the 2025 Bond, **we have earmarked $1.1 million to ensure curriculum resources (including portfolio projects) will celebrate and preserve Native history, culture, and contributions,** ensuring that every student has access to an inclusive and accurate education.

In addition, we will hire a Tribal Liaison

To deepen our partnership with Native families and ensure sustained engagement, **we will hire a Tribal Liaison for the upcoming 2025-2026 school year.** This role will align with practices seen at the City of Portland, Multnomah County, Metro, and the Governor's Office, where tribal liaisons build bridges among and between governmental entities and Native communities. The Tribal Liaison will collaborate with jurisdictional partners and serve as a crucial voice for our Native students and families.

We will work on Strengthening Pathways and Relationships

We are committed to continuous learning while strengthening our relationship with Portland State University's Native Teacher and Administrator Pathway program. **In partnership with the community, we will also establish clear K-12 pathways** to support Native students as they navigate their educational journeys.

We will also develop Professional Learning Priorities

In partnership with our Tribal Liaison, we will develop mandatory professional learning opportunities for all of our staff. This effort will ensure that our educators are well-equipped to honor the unique cultural identities of Native students while fostering an inclusive and supportive learning environment.

It’s important that we create Spaces for Programs

We recognize the importance of providing safe and welcoming spaces for Native students and their elders. **Some of our modernized buildings can be designated as Native-focused centers.** For instance, three of our high schools collectively serve 300 Native students. With modernized facilities available, we are eager to collaborate with the community to identify the ideal location for such a center.

It’s personally important to me that we Rise Together.

This is just the beginning. I invite you to partner with us in co-creating a process that honors your voices and reflects the unique needs of Native families and students. Your input will guide our work, ensuring that these initiatives are meaningful and impactful.

We stand ready to meet with the community on March 3, 2025 at 6 p.m., to discuss this work. More information will come in late January.


TOGETHER,
WE RISE
PPS
PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS